

SOX BUILD BOND WITH HOLIEST FAN

At the Vatican, team's future majority owner envisions a future blessed by Pope Leo XIV, writes Paul Sullivan. **Chicago Sports**

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Chicago Tribune



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THURSDAY, NOVEMBER 20, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Man sentenced for shooting boy

Nine years after shots wounded 10-year-old on Lawndale porch, victim's family looks to future

By **Tess Kenny**
Chicago Tribune

Huddled around a pair of tables on the second-floor cafeteria of Chicago's Dirksen U.S. Courthouse, mother Mellanie Washington and daughter Taniyah Tanner spoke about future plans. They prattled about diplomas to be earned, careers to build, healing to last. They laughed. They reminisced.

It was a moment more than nine years in the making.

In a hearing Wednesday afternoon, a federal judge handed down the maximum sentence to a man who earlier this summer admitted to the 2016 shooting of Washington's son and Taniyah's twin brother, Tavon Tanner.

U.S. District Judge Jorge Alonso sentenced Terrance White, 32, to 10 years in federal prison after

White pleaded guilty in June to attempted murder in aid of racketeering activity for the nearly decade-old shooting of then-10-year-old Tavon. White was also ordered to pay nearly \$279,000 in restitution.

"(The) sentence here is not going to make up for what he did," Alonso said Wednesday as he handed down his order, with Washington and Taniyah watching from the courtroom. "(It) will never make up for what he did."

Turn to Sentence, Page 5

Taniyah Tanner and her mother, Mellanie Washington, leave the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse on Wednesday, after the sentencing of a man who shot then-10-year-old Tavon Tanner in 2016. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



U.S. Attorney Andrew Boutros, right, talks about federal domestic terrorism charges filed Wednesday against a suspect who allegedly set a 26-year-old woman on fire on a CTA Blue Line train. CTA's acting President Nora Leerhsen stands at left. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Suspect faces terror charge after CTA rider set on fire

50-year-old man accused in attack on Blue Line shouts 'I plead guilty!' during court appearance

By **Caroline Kubzansky, Talia Soglin and Jason Meisner**
Chicago Tribune

Federal authorities said a man in all black approached a young woman on a Blue Line train late Monday, took out an iced tea bottle and poured clear liquid onto the woman's head. Then he set her on fire.

Lawrence Reed allegedly stood at the front of the train car and watched as the 26-year-old woman, "engulfed in flames,"

rolled on the floor of the train trying to snuff out the blaze.

Prosecutors Wednesday afternoon charged Reed, of Chicago, with a single count of terrorism against a mass transportation system for the apparently unprovoked attack in an unusual 13-page complaint filed in U.S. District Court.

Speaking to reporters after the hearing, U.S. Attorney Andrew Boutros said the victim remained in critical condition Wednesday.

Turn to Terror, Page 5



Lawrence Reed, 50, of Chicago, faces a federal charge after he allegedly poured gasoline on a 26-year-old woman riding a CTA Blue Line train and set her on fire late Monday, police claimed. **U.S. DISTRICT COURT**

DOJ admits to error in case against Comey

Full grand jury didn't see final indictment

By **Eric Tucker and Michael Kunzelman**
Associated Press

ALEXANDRIA, Va. — The prosecution of former FBI Director James Comey hit another hurdle Wednesday as the Justice

Department acknowledged a possible lapse in how the case was presented to a federal grand jury for indictment.

The concession risked further imperiling a politically charged prosecution already subject to multiple challenges and demands for its dismissal. It came during a hearing in which Comey's lawyers asked U.S. District Judge Michael Nachmanoff to throw out the case

on grounds that the government was being vindictive. A separate challenge to Lindsey Halligan, the hastily appointed and inexperienced prosecutor who secured the indictment, is pending.

The revelation that the full grand jury did not review a copy of the final indictment in the case is the latest indication of the Justice Department's seemingly disjointed pursuit of criminal

charges against Comey. He was fired by President Donald Trump in May 2017 while overseeing an FBI investigation into potential ties between Russia and Trump's 2016 campaign. The two have been publicly at odds ever since, with Trump deriding Comey as "a weak and untruthful slime ball" and calling for his prosecution.

Turn to Comey, Page 9

ICC cuts Nicor Gas rate hike by 47%

Average customers will pay \$4.25 more per month next year

By **Robert Channick**
Chicago Tribune

The Illinois Commerce Commission slashed a proposed \$314.3 million Nicor Gas rate increase by nearly 47% Wednesday, keeping a lid on rising energy bills for many suburban Chicago customers next year.

The ruling, issued during an open meeting in Chicago, reduces Nicor's rate hike by \$146.5 million. For customers, that translates to an average increase of about \$4.25 per month beginning with the January bill, the utility told the Tribune.

"The ICC's responsibility is to balance the interests of Illinois' utilities and their consumers," ICC Chair Doug Scott said in a news release. "We recognize that any decision impacting Illinoisans' bills is not a small one, and after careful review of Nicor's proposed investments, the Commission opted to strike excess charges and approve necessary and justified projects."

Nicor filed in January for the largest gas rate increase in Illinois history, saying it needed to replace aging infrastructure and

Turn to Nicor, Page 4

INSIDE Trump signs Epstein bill

President Donald Trump signed legislation Wednesday to release additional files from the investigation into convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein. But even as Trump signs the bill, the administration has signaled that might not mean a full release of every file from the probe. **Nation & World**

■ Latest drop of Epstein emails reveal more correspondence with Gov. JB Pritzker's cousin. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

REVERSAL ON FEDS' USE OF FORCE: A Chicago federal appeals court on Wednesday put the brakes on a lower court's injunction restricting the use of force in Operation Midway Blitz. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High **54** Low **43**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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